

In 1990, Jonathan Waldern presented *Virtuality*, a series of VR arcade machines. The players would wear a headset to see visuals while sitting down on the machine and providing inputs on the armrest. While some brains were busy developing the technology, films like *Brainstorm* and *The Lawnmower Man* were popularizing VR amongst the masses.

The VR entered or at least tried to enter houses of its users when Sega announced Sega VR in 1991. But due to technical difficulties, the device forever remained as a prototype. Now that Sega had taken their shot, Nintendo simply couldn't sit back and watch. Enter Nintendo Virtual Boy. Considered one of the worst failures of the gaming industry, the device was expensive for what it did and how it felt. It featured incredible black and red graphics, discomfort and a variety of headaches.

The difficulty that Sega faced with its VR technology and the gruesome downfall of Virtual Boy led to a hiatus in the video game VR industry. This silence was broken almost two decades later when Oculus slammed the Rift on the hearts of gamers.

Summoning of the Big Three

Although Oculus took the modern VR baton first, it sure isn't the most important one. Valve revealed its partnership with HTC for the Vive. Sony quickly took the opportunity by announcing Project Morpheus, later titled PlayStation VR, exclusively for PlayStation 4. Although PSVR demands a significantly lower expenditure than the other two, it sure runs in the same league of titans. All the three companies have been bringing extensive amounts of VR content onto their platforms. Even though the mobile territory may seem far less daunting with its more comfortable prices, the true VR experience lies with the big three.

Launch price, what's in the box and what extra would you need

PlayStation VR launched with a price tag of \$399. Inside the box you get the headset, an extension to the PS4 which provides the extra bit of power the headset needs and a cable extension, a pair of earphones with different sizes of buds, a demo disk and wires. The PSVR requires the PlayStation camera, so if you didn't get that in a bundle, it'll set you back around \$50. If you want increase your immersion beyond the PS controllers, you may have to drop another \$100 for the, slightly outdated, move controllers.